Cornell University

ROPER CENTER

31090617
USCBS1976-NATELEC

Country: United States

Title: CBS News Poll: 1976 National Election Day Exit Poll

Survey Organizations: CBS News

Field Dates: November 2, 1976

Sample: Exiting Voters

Sample Size: 15300

Interview Modes: Mail questionnaire/Self-enumerated questionnaire

Weight Location: Columns 14-18 (xx.xxx) -- Varname: WGT

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1976 CBS Election Day Exit Poll

SECRET BALLOT (A) | CBS ELECTION DAY POLL 1 2 (B) | SECRET BALLOT 1 2 3

[C} IN THE PRESIDENTIAL ELECTION
WHO DID YOU JUST VOTE FOR?
(27)

1. [ ] GERALD FORD

2. [ ] JIMMY CARTER

3. [ ] EUGENE McCARTHY

4. [ ] LESTER MADDOX

5. [ ] DIDN'T VOTE FOR PRESIDENT

6. [ ] OTHER _____
(please specify)

[D] WHY DID YOU VOTE FOR HIM? (Check "X" up to 3 boxes)
(28-29), (30-31), (32-33)

1. [ ] He's my party's candidate.
2. [ ] He seems more capable.
3. [ ] He's not part of the crowd running things now.
4. [ ] He impressed me during the debates.
5. [ ] I feel more comfortable with him.
6. [ ] He's the lesser of two evils.
7. [ ] I trust him.
8. [ ] He has strong qualities of leadership.
9. [ ] He cares about people like me.
10. [ ] I like his Vice-President.

[E] WHICH OF THESE ISSUES LED YOU TO VOTE FOR YOUR CANDIDATE? (Check "X" up to 3 boxes)
(34-35), (36-37), (38-39)

1. [ ] Restoring trust to government.
2. [ ] Job guarantees.
3. [ ] Federal taxes.
4. [ ] Special interests of big business.
5. [ ] Watergate and the pardon.
6. [ ] Foreign affairs.
7. [ ] Controlling inflation.
8. [ ] Streamlining the government.
9. [ ] Welfare reform.
10. [ ] Religious views.

[F] WHEN DID YOU DECIDE WHO TO VOTE FOR?

(40)

1. [ ] Knew all along
2. [ ] During the Primaries
3. [ ] During the Conventions
4. [ ] During the debates
5. [ ] After the debates
6. [ ] During last few days

[G] IS THERE ANYTHING THAT YOU DISLIKE AB0UT GERALD FORD? (Check "X" up to 3 boxes) (41), (42), (43)

1. [ ] He has too many ties to Big Business.
2. [ ] He hasn't been "frank" about his campaign funds.
3. [ ] He's not really running the Government.
4. [ ] He pardoned Nixon.
5. [ ] He's not intelligent enough to be President.
6. [ ] He's just like any other politician.
7. [ ] What he said about Eastern Europe.
8. [ ] He's a Republican.

[H] IS THERE ANYTHING THAT YOU DISLIKE ABOUT JIMMY CARTER (Check "X'' up to 3 boxes) (44), (45), (46)

1. [ ] He has too many ties to Labor.
2. [ ] He attacks President Ford unfairly.
3. [ ] I'm uncomfortable with all his religious talk.
4. [ ] I don't really trust him.
5. [ ] He's not big enough for the job.
6. [ ] I didn't like his Playboy interview.
7. [ ] I'm not sure I know what he stands for.
8. [ ] He's a Southerner.

[I] DID YOU VOTE FOR THE REPUBLICAN OR THE DEMOCRATIC CANDIDATE FOR THE U.S. HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES? (47)

1. [ ] REPUBLICAN
2. [ ] DEMOCRATIC
3. [ ] SOME OTHER PARTY
4. [ ] DIDN'T VOTE FOR HOUSE

PLEASE TURN BALLOT OVER

PLEASE ANSWER EACH QUESTION

[J] IF TODAY'S ELECTION HAD BEEN BETWEEN
GERALD FORD AND HUBERT HUMPHEY
WHO WOULD YOU HAVE VOTED FOR? (48)

1. [ ] FORD 2. [ ] HUMPHREY

[K] IF TODAY'S ELECTION HAD BEEN BETWEEN
RONALD REAGAN AND JIMMY CARTER
WHO WOULD YOU HAVE VOTED FOR? (49)

1. [ ] REAGAN 2. [ ] CARTER

[L] IF TODAY'S ELECTION HAD BEEN BETWEEN
GERALD FORD AND EDWARD KENNEDY,
WHO WOULD YOU HAVE VOTED FOR? (50)

1. [ ] FORD 2. [ ] KENNEDY

[M] DO YOU USUALLY THINK OF YOURSELF AS A
(51)

1. [ ] REPUBLICAN 3. [ ] INDEPENDENT
2. [ ] DEMOCRAT

[N] IF YOUR STATE HAD A PRESIDENTIAL PRIMARY,
WHO DID YOU VOTE FOR? (52-53)

1. [ ] NO PRIMARY 6. [ ] JACKSON
2 [ ] FORD 7. [ ] UDALL
3 [ ] REAGAN 8. [ ] WALLACE
4. [ ] BROWN 9. [ ] OTHER DEMOCRAT
5. [ ] CARTER 10. [ ] DIDN'T VOTE

[O] IN 1972, FOR WHOM DID YOU VOTE? (54)

1. [ ] NIXON
2. [ ] MCGOVERN
3. [ ] SOMEONE ELSE
4. [ ] DID NOT VOTE

[P] ON MOST POLITICAL MATTERS DO YOU
CONSIDER YOURSELF (55)

1. [ ] LIBERAL 3. [ ] CONSERVATIVE
2. [ ] MODERATE

[Q] OCCUPATION OF THE HEAD OF YOUR HOUSEHOLD: (56)

1. [ ] PROFESSIONAL OR MANAGER
2. [ ] CLERICAL/SALES/OTHER WHITE COLLAR
3. [ ] SKILLED, UNSKILLED OR BLUE COLLAR WORKER
4. [ ] LOOKING FOR WORK
5. [ ] OTHER

[R] TO WHICH AGE GROUP DO YOU BELONG? (57)

1. [ ] 18-21
2. [ ] 22-29
3. [ ] 30-44
4. [ ] 45-59
5. [ ] 60 OR OVER

[S] WHAT RELIGION WERE YOU BROUGHT UP IN? (58)

1. [ ] PROTESTANT
2. [ ] CATHOLIC
3. [ ] JEWISH
4. [ ] OTHER
5. [ ] NONE

[T] ARE YOU OR IS ANYONE LIVING IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD A UNION MEMBER? (59)

1. [ ] YES
2. [ ] NO

[U] 1975 TOTAL FAMILY INCOME (60)

1. [ ] UNDER $8,000
2. [ ] $8,000-$12,000
3. [ ] $12,001-$20,000
4. [ ] OVER $20,000

[V] DID YOU HEAR ANY NATIONAL ELECTION RETURNS ON EITHER TELEVISION OR RADIO TODAY? (Not Available)

1. [ ] NO
2. [ ] YES... WHAT TIME DID YOU HEAR THE RETURNS?

TIME _____

ELECTION SURVEYS, 1976

BACKGROUND

CBS News and The New York Times were partners in a series of surveys, covering the 1976 presidential campaign. The surveys were supposed to provide another dimension to the political reporting of the two organizations. The survey plans called for extensive coverage early in the primary campaign. The Democrats, still smarting over their selection of McGovern four years earlier, ad the Republicans, trying to overcome the image of Watergate, would both be seeking a strong presidential candidate. The successful candidates would have to separate themselves from their parties' image and, they would have to do it in the preference primaries. The surveys were designed to monitor the public's changing perception of (1) the candidates, (2) the issues, and (3) the candidates' position vis a vis the issues. It was the intention of the two news organizations to reduce speculation in their campaign reporting about the voting public's state of mind. As a consequence of these and other major survey efforts, reporting of the 1976 presidential campaign contained far less reliance on "leaked" candidate polls than ever before, and in some ways, a dependence on the polls done exclusively for public consumption. The candidates' polls had a decided role in setting the agenda for the campaign. The public polls provided information to the media and the voters.

GENERAL INFORMATION

There were two different types of surveys. The first were ten separate nationwide surveys, conducted by telephone with approximately 1500 randomly selected adults each. Five surveys were conducted monthly from February through June, four more between early September and the general election following each presidential debate, and a final survey was conducted two days after the general election.

The second set of surveys were done on election or primary day. The interviews were conducted at the polling place among a random sample of people that had just voted. These surveys were conducted in the following primary states: California, Florida, Illinois, Indiana, Massachusetts, Michigan, New Hampshire, New York, Ohio, Oregon, Pennsylvania and Wisconsin. Additionally for the presidential election, there was a nation-wide election day survey conducted with voters throughout the nation.

TELEPHONE SURVEYS

Sampling Procedure:

The individuals comprising the sample in the CBS News/New York Times nationwide surveys were selected through a variation of random-digit dialing.l Primary sampling units are blocks of 100 telephone numbers, identical through the eighth digit (Area Code-Exchange-XX _). The PSU's were stratified by geographic region, area code and size of place. The first stage selection was systematic with a uniform rate, from a complete list of all existing area codes and exchanges in the conterminous United States. The last two digits were randomly assigned to form a "seed" number within each PSU. The number was called for a screening interview. Only if it was a working residential number, was the PSU retained in the sample. Once a PSU met that initial requirement, the block of 100 telephone numbers associated with

it remained a PSU throughout 1976. Two residences were to be contacted within a PSU for each survey. The actual telephone numbers for each survey were selected in small groups (replicates), to permit varying sample sizes, while still retaining geographic distribution.

The initial screening of a PSU takes advantage of the telephone company's practice of assigning working telephone numbers in blocks of l00's or l000's before starting a new block. The design is self-weighting, as the likelihood of an eight digit group or "block" being selected as a PSU is exactly proportional to the number of working numbers in the block.

Respondents were selected within household using a method developed by Kish, and modified by Backstrom and Hursh.3 The probability of selection depends on the size of household. The procedure provides an unbiased selection of households of fewer than five adults. The respondent selection controls for sex and the relative age composition of the household.

The nationwide surveys conducted during the primary campaign (February, March, April, May, and June) include an over-sampling of Republicans in order to insure that the number of Republicans would be large enough for detailed analysis. To do this, additional random replicates beyond those used to obtain the original sample were utilized. In these addition-replicates, only Republican respondents were interviewed. Respondents are identified as having been selected as part of the additional sample of Republicans or selected with the original sample by a code in card 1, col. 20 of each survey. The weights for all respondents reflect the actual probability of selection, including this over sampling.

WEIGHTING PROCEDURE

The weight assigned to each respondent is the inverse of the probability of selection, modified by a series of ratio estimates. Each succeeding ratio estimate was superimposed on the previous weight. The first stages essentially a non-interview adjustment within geographic region. or each region, an adjustment was made to approximate the number of adults in the region. In the next stage, race by sex were the ratio estimate characteristics, and the final stage was age by education. (On occasion, because of a small number of sample cases in some cells at the final stage, some educational groups were collapsed within age categories.)

The weights computed in the manner described are the dimension of the adult population of the United States. For convenience, all weights were reduced by a constant so that the resulting sum of the weights is the sample size. A weight is assigned to each sample record, and MUST be used for all tabulations and analysis.

In all national surveys, the weights appear on card 1, cols. 76-80. There are three implied decimal places (F5.3).

NOTE: Respondent number does not reflect order of selection. Any variance computation that assumes order of selection will require simulating that order from the sample design.

PRIMARY DAY AND ELECTION DAY SURVEYS

The primary and election day surveys were conducted at the polling place among a sample of voters immediately after they cast their votes. The precincts are a random sub-sample of those used by CBS News for estimating the election outcome. Sample precincts were selected with probability proportionate to the total vote cast in a recent past election. The sampling frame consisted of all precincts in a state, stratified by party vote and geography. Within precincts, respondents are selected on a systematic random basis. The interviewer had no control over respondent selection.

Weights for the primary and election day surveys appear in columns 6 to 80, of each poll, and MUST be used in any data analysis. Weights are computed taking into account he probability of selection, a non-interview adjustment and a ratio estimate to the final vote totals. All weights were reduced by a constant so that the sum of the weights is the sample size.

REINTERVIEWS

During the primaries, there was an attempt to re-interview respondents who had been interviewed once before. Half of each survey was supposed to be respondents from the prior month. The procedure was not successful. Respondents interviewed for two months are identified for whatever marginal interest they may have. (See Pre-Conventions Surveys, Card 1, Columns 1-4 DESCRIPTION). Additionally, files have been created for analysis of the interviewed respondents, with responses from both interviews included.

There was re-interviewing of respondents during the fal1 surveys also. All respondents in the survey conducted after Debate One were initially interviewed in early September. The Post-Election survey includes as many of the people as possible that were first interviewed for the Debate Three survey. Those who were registered-to-vote have completed interviews in both surveys included in the Post-Election survey file. Those identified as not registered from the Debate Three survey were .also interviewed post election. The re-interviewed respondents are not a randomly selected subset of those initially interviewed, but are those respondents successfully contacted. Re-weighting was done on the re-interviewed group.

1) The sampling procedure used for these surveys was designed by Warren J. Mitofsky in 1770 for CBS News surveys. The optimization of the procedure was done by Joseph Waksberg at the request of CBS and recently published. See Joseph Waksberg, "Sampling Methods for Random Digit Dialing," Journal of the American Statistical Association. (Vol. 73) March, 1978, pp. 40-46.

2) Size of place strata were crudely determined by using the geographic coordinates of the places where the central offices are located. These coordinates are assigned by the phone company to every exchange. All exchanges in the same city would have the same coordinates. Large and small city strata were defined by counting the number of exchanges per pair of coordinates. Suburbs are exchanges within 15 miles of large cities. The last stratum includes the remaining exchanges. The number of working residential phone numbers per exchange varies considerably by stratum.

3) Charles H. Backstrom and Gerald D. Hursh, Survey Research. Northwestern University Press, 1963, pp. 52-58.

CBS ELECTION DAY POLL

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CARD 1

COLUMN	DESCRIPTION
19	Region 1. Northeast (CT, DC, Del, MD, NH, ME, RI, Mass, WV, NJ, PA, VT.) 2. New York 3. Midwest (IL, IN, IO, KS, MI, MN, MO, NE, ND, SD, OH, WI.) 4. South (AL, FL, KY, MI, OK, TE, VA, AR, GA, LA, NC, SC, TX.) 5. West (AZ, CO, MO, NM, UT, WY, ID, NV, OR, WA.) 6. California
20-22	Precinct Number
23-24	Hour of Voting (Coded by Interviewer)
25	Sex (Coded by Interviewer) 1. Male 2. Female
26	Race (Coded by Interviewer) 1. White/Other 2. Black 3. Spanish-speaking
14-18	Weight- 3 decimal places implied

NOTE: In New York and California, Question "I" – Column 47- asked- “In the Senatorial Election, who did you just vote for?”

NEW YORK	CALIFORNIA
l= JAMES BUCKLEY	l= S.I. HAYAKAWA
2= DANIEL MOYNIHAN	2= JOHN TUNNEY
3= SOME OTHER CANDIDATE	3= SOME OTHER CANDIDATE
4= DID NOT VOTE FOR SENATE	4= DID NOT VOTE FOR SENATE